

Water Breathing

“Warrior of Breathing” — the Monastery Form

“Be water. Water does not strike — it flows, and the rock is cut all the same. Now breathe, and begin again.”

— Master Kaelon Windstep

The Warrior of Water Breathing is the form of the patient master — the discipline that other monks spend their whole lives chasing. Its practitioners learn to move like a river: never rigid, never still, every strike flowing into the next, every blow turned aside by giving way rather than resisting. When they ignite their breath, their blade runs pale blue and cold, and their guard becomes as fluid and unbroken as a current that cannot be grasped.

It is the most traditional of the breathing forms, and the hardest to truly master, for it asks the warrior to be calm in the middle of chaos. Those who walk this path are as often menders as fighters — for the same stillness that turns a blade can also close a wound, and the same patience that wins a duel can sit a long vigil at a friend’s side.

Water Breathing Features

Monk Level	Feature
3rd	Water Breathing
6th	First Form: Flowing Strike
11th	Advanced Water Breathing; Healing Spring
17th	Third Form: Tidal Crash

Level 3 — Water Breathing

Igniting the Breath. When you roll Initiative, you can spend 1 ki point to ignite your breath for the rest of the combat (until the combat ends, you have the Incapacitated condition, or you choose to end it as a Free Action). Your weapon glows pale blue and deals an extra **2 cold damage** on every hit.

Flowing Guard. While your breath is ignited, you gain **+2 Armor Class against the first attack made against you before each of your turns** — an ever-moving guard that turns the first blow aside.

The blade is meant to be a katana or other monk weapon; its bonus damage applies to weapon attacks made with it.

Level 6 — First Form: Flowing Strike

First Form: Flowing Strike. As a **Bonus Action**, you can spend **1 ki point** to shift up to **15 feet** without provoking Opportunity Attacks and make one weapon attack with your monk weapon. On a hit, the attack deals **3d8 + your Dexterity modifier** cold damage, and the target must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw against your ki save DC or be knocked **Prone** as the current sweeps its feet.

This replaces your Flurry of Blows as your Bonus Action for the turn.

Level 11 — Advanced Water Breathing & Healing Spring

Advanced Breathing. Your ignited breath deepens. While it is active you gain all its original benefits, and now also: whenever you **hit a creature with your monk weapon**, that creature's Speed is reduced by **10 feet** until the start of your next turn as the cold seeps into its limbs.

Sharpened Flow. The damage of your *First Form: Flowing Strike* increases to **5d10 + your Dexterity modifier**.

Healing Spring. Once per **Long Rest**, you can take a **Bonus Action** to touch a creature (or yourself) and channel the still water's mending. The target regains **4d8 + your Wisdom modifier** hit points.

The same calm that turns a blade can close a wound. Many Water warriors become the quiet heart of their company.

Level 17 — Third Form: Tidal Crash

Third Form: Tidal Crash. As a **Bonus Action**, you can spend **3 ki points** to shift up to **20 feet** and make one weapon attack against **up to three different creatures** within your reach as you flow among them. Each attack deals **5d10 + your Dexterity modifier** cold damage on a hit. **Bonus:** each creature hit must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw against your ki save DC or be knocked **Prone** and have its Speed reduced to **0** until the end of its next turn, frozen in place by the flood.

AT LEVEL 7, STABBY HAS: Water Breathing (Level 3 stance) + First Form: Flowing Strike (Level 6, 3d8+DEX). The Level 11 and 17 features unlock as he grows.